and well-respected magistrate by the name of Rai Sahib Pandit Sri Kishen for some ten months from 10 April 1929 until 1 May 1930, by which time over 200 witnesses had already been examined and the remaining number would have been too without any significant delay if only he had been allowed to carry on. And, they would say that it is therefore astonishing that ongoing proceedings, from which a right of appeal created by the Imperial Parliament in London would have lain to the Lahore High Court, was aborted by a governor-general acting on his own volition in India. It is the manner of his trial, leading up to his eventual execution which is so blatantly wrong, that we must now consider. It is important to remember, however, that there was more than one trial. As Binda Preet Sahni has confirmed, 'The Bhagat Singh Litigation covered three trials known as the *Delhi Assembly Bomb Case, Second Lahore Conspiracy Case, and the Bhagat Singh v. Emperor* on 2 February 1931.'[2] Of these, the first was the least controversial, whereas the other two were more so, in ascending order, which is why this chapter focuses on these two trials.

The FIR, which is written in Urdu, was procured by Pakistani lawyer Imtiaz Qureshi in 2019 after eight decades, following a trawl through the Anarkali Police Station files. It makes the following clear. First, the Delhi Bomb Case started on 7 May 1929 in Delhi before the sessions judge, under Section 307 of the Indian Penal Code.[3] Here Bhagat Singh defended himself with the help of a legal adviser, Mr Asaf Ali. In less than one week, both Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt were convicted and transported for life on 12 June 1929. On 14 June 1929, Bhagat Singh was transferred to Mianwali and B.K. Dutt was sent to Lahore Jail. The next day, on 15 June 1929, Bhagat Singh went on a hunger strike, asking to be given political prisoner status. It was then that he was moved to Lahore Jail. In the meantime, there, on 13 September 1929, Jatindra Das died on hunger strike. Bhagat Singh and others ended their hunger strike on 4 October 1929, even though they were still not being granted political prisoner status, despite the fact that the Punjab High Court recognized Bhagat Singh as a 'sincere revolutionary'. Second, there was the Lahore Conspiracy Case trial, which was conducted by Special Magistrate Rai Sahib Pandit Kishen Chand.